



The Charles Blow Show – Product Plan

A product-management approach to launching, growing, and monetizing **The Charles Blow Show** as a multi-platform political media brand.

Product thesis: Charles Blow is a trusted, incisive voice on American politics, race, and power. The "product" is not a single video — it is a *recurring relationship* with an audience that wants to feel informed, seen, and equipped to act. Every platform is a different doorway into the same experience.

The Product (positioning in one line)

"The smartest seat at the table on race, politics, and power in America — in conversation."

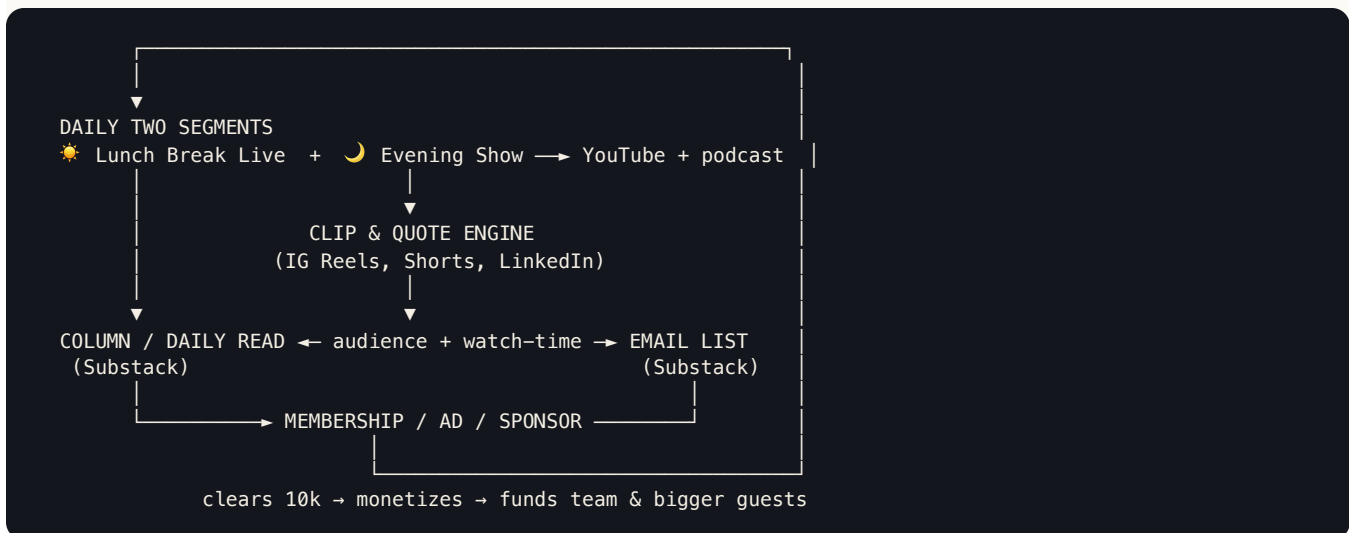
A host-led, **daily two-segment** show — ☀️ *Lunch Break Live* (10 min, live, Blow's immediate read on the day's biggest story) and 🌙 *The Evening Show* (20 min, high-profile guest conversation) — that pairs columnist-grade commentary with deep guest conversations, delivered as appointment viewing across YouTube, Instagram, Substack, and LinkedIn, anchored by www.charlesblowshow.com.

The plan: start lean and deliberate, grow the audience through consistent daily output, and build a team that raises production value over time. Success climbs a three-rung ladder — **(1) monetization** (cross YouTube's 10k-subscriber threshold), **(2) audience growth**, **(3) profitability** (recurring revenue > production cost). Full detail in 06.

Documents in this plan

DOC	WHAT IT COVERS
01-product-strategy.md	Vision, audience, positioning, value prop, business model, success metrics
02-content-programming.md	Daily / weekly / monthly segment formats and the content engine
03-platform-strategy.md	YouTube, Instagram, Substack, LinkedIn — role, cadence, formats, KPIs
04-website-spec.md	charlesblowshow.com — sitemap, features, tech stack, build plan
05-guest-roadmap.md	Incremental "ladder" of political guests + booking strategy
06-roadmap-and-metrics.md	The 3-rung success ladder, phased launch roadmap, KPIs, OKRs, team & budget
07-video-production.md	Production plan for both daily segments — lean→scaled kit, live pipeline, clip engine, roles
08-daily-production-runbook.md	The daily operating manual + a fill-in call sheet for both segments
09-editorial-calendar.md	Week-by-week calendar mapping segments + clips + column across all 4 platforms
10-brand-guidelines.md	Visual identity — logo, ink/paper/ember palette, Newsreader + Inter type, components, voice

The product flywheel



Each day's two segments produce a column/note, a newsletter slot, ~6+ clips, and a community thread. Daily output compounds watch-time → clears YouTube's 10k gate → unlocks revenue → funds bigger guests and higher production value → which grows the audience further.

Quick-start: the first 90 days

1. **Lock the brand system** — name, logo, color, set design, lower-thirds, segment + clip templates (07).
2. **Stand up the lean production kit** — audio-first, single camera, the live pipeline for *Lunch Break Live* (07).
3. **Stand up charlesblowshow.com** (see 04) with email capture live on day one.
4. **Bank 3–4 evergreen Evening Shows** before public launch (never launch empty).
5. **Launch Substack** as the owned-audience anchor; cross-post column + daily Read.
6. **Run both segments daily, Mon–Fri** — consistency is the whole game; drive toward **10k YouTube subs** (Rung 1).
7. **Ship the clip pipeline** — each day yields **≥6 short clips** within 48 hrs.
8. **Run the guest ladder** — start with reachable allies, climb toward marquee names.

See [06-roadmap-and-metrics.md](#) for the full phased plan and the 3-rung success ladder.